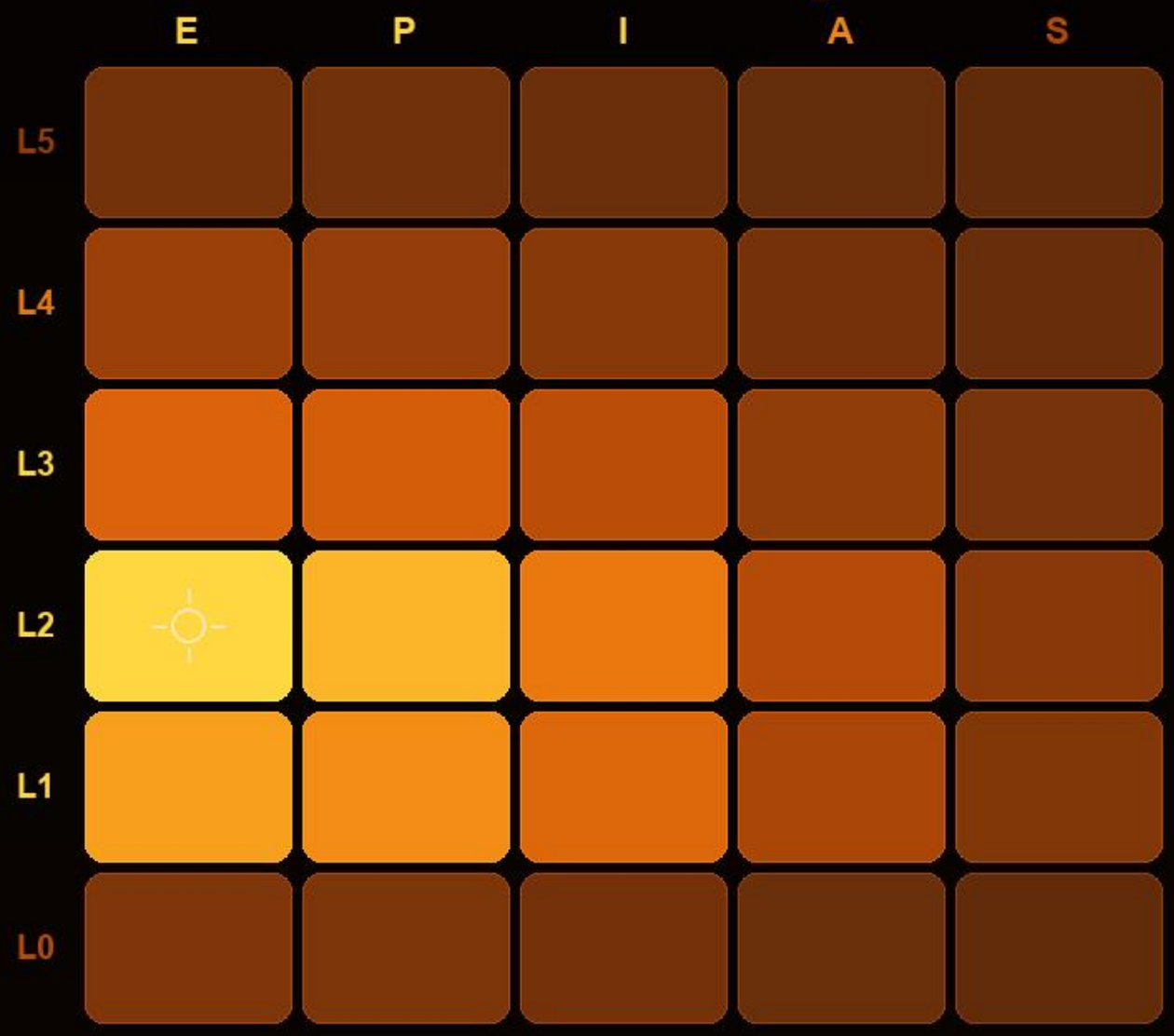
Where are you on the
AI Skills Map?



For designers & UX researchers

Swipe to find your coordinates →

Automation Skills

How much of your design or research work is AI-driven?

L0

L0 — Manual

You do the work. Tools don't decide or generate.

L1

L1 — AI-Assisted

AI suggests. You decide. Cognitive load drops, not responsibility.

L2

L2 — Partially Automated

AI builds bounded pieces. You assemble, integrate, and verify.

L3

L3 — Guided Automation

You own the checkpoints. Work spans sessions, not just prompts.

L4

L4 — Mostly Automated

Work runs while you sleep. You own the rules, not the steps.

L5

L5 — AI × AI

You set goals and constraints. AI does the rest. (Not yet real.)

Leadership Skills

How mature is your use of AI?

E

Explorer

Trying things out.

Results vary. Still learning what works.

P

Practitioner

Consistent habits.

Repeatable techniques. Process is reliable.

I

Integrator

Fully in your workflow.

Documented decisions. Traceable outputs.

A

Architect

You build systems.

Templates others adopt and trust.

S

Steward

You set the standard.

Mentor others. Govern practice org-wide.

Find your location on the AI Skills Map
and plot your course.

“A Steward at L1 is more valuable than an Explorer at L4.”

— John Maeda, DIT 2026

Find your coordinates.

3 minutes · Anonymous · No login

aiskillsmap.noahratzan.com

Link in first comment ↓

Based on John Maeda's DIT 2026 framework
presented at SXSW 2026